PRIMARY FIVE ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Term One | Week 5 | Lesson 6

QUESTION TAGS

Learning objectives

- Explain the meaning of question tags.

- Recognise and use the correct sentence patterns.

- Write clear and correct sentences in this lesson.

Meaning

A question tag is a short question added at the end of a statement to ask for confirmation.

Important rules

- A positive statement usually takes a negative tag: She is here, isn't she?

- A negative statement usually takes a positive tag: He is not late, is he?

- Use the same helping verb when possible; if there is none in the present or past simple, use do, does or did.

Examples

1. You are ready, aren't you?

2. He is not sleepy, is he?

3. Amina sings well, doesn't she?

4. They played yesterday, didn't they?

5. We have finished, haven't we?

6. The pupils cannot swim, can they?

Worked example

Question: Add tag: The bell rang.

Answer: The bell rang, didn't it?

Common mistakes

Incorrect	Correct
She is here, is she?	She is here, isn't she?
He does not know, doesn't he?	He does not know, does he?
We went home, don't we?	We went home, didn't we?
They can sing, cannot they?	They can sing, can't they?

PRACTICE EXERCISES

A. Complete the sentences or expressions.

1. She is a teacher, ___?

_____

2. They are late, ___?

_____

3. He cannot swim, ___?

_____

4. You played, ___?

_____

5. We have finished, ___?

_____

6. Musa reads, ___?

_____

B. Rewrite or correct as instructed.

7. Add tag: The bell rang.

_____

_____

8. Add tag: The girls are ready.

_____

_____

9. Correct: He is ill, is he?

_____

_____

10. Add tag: Asha does not sing.

_____

_____

C. Find and correct the mistakes.

11. She is here, is she?

_____

12. He does not know, doesn’t he?

_____

13. We went home, don’t we?

_____

14. They can sing, cannot they?

_____

D. Read and answer.

15. State one important rule from this lesson.

_____

_____

16. Write one correct example related to this lesson.

_____

_____

17. Explain the meaning of the grammar form studied.

_____

_____

E. Write your own sentences.

18. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

_____

19. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

_____

20. Write one clear sentence using the grammar studied in this lesson.

_____

Remember

- A positive statement usually takes a negative tag: She is here, isn’t she?

- A negative statement usually takes a positive tag: He is not late, is he?

- Use the same helping verb when possible; if there is none in the present or past simple, use do, does or did.